# Data Science

BSc Computer Science - Durham University

Matthew Emerson

November 2026

# Contents

**1 Module Introduction** **1**
1.1 Assessment . . . 1
1.2 Timetable . . . 1

**2 Probability and Statistics** **1**
2.1 Probability and Statistics: Basic Concepts . . . 1
2.2 Dependency and Bayes Theorem . . . 3
2.3 Discrete Probability Distributions . . . 4
2.4 Continuous Probability Distributions . . . 7
2.5 Normal (Gaussian) Distributions . . . 9
2.6 Correlations . . . 10
2.7 Central Limit Theorem and Sampling . . . 10
2.8 Hypothesis Testing . . . 10
2.9 Data Types and Visualisation . . . 10
2.10 Basic Data Analysis with Python . . . 10

**3 Data Cleaning and Analytics** **10**
3.1 Data Quality and How to Produce High-Quality Data . . . 10
3.2 Working with Files . . . 11
3.3 Pandas and Numpy . . . 11
3.4 Data Cleaning and Preparation . . . 11
3.5 Python Data Visualisation Libraries . . . 12
3.6 Data Analytics and Reporting . . . 12

**4 Computer Graphics** **12**

**5 Image Processing** **12**

**I Appendix** **13**

**6 Bibliography** **13**
6.1 Module Professors . . . 13
6.2 References . . . 13
6.3 List of Figures . . . 13
6.4 Reading List . . . 13

# 1 Module Introduction

Data Science has the module code COMP2271 and is led by Professor Thomas Erlebach.

## 1.1 Assessment

This module is assessed through two pieces of summative coursework and two final exams, these can be seen in Table 1. Additional formatives are also shown in italics.

| Title | Opening | Due | Feedback | Professor | Weight |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Data Cleaning & Analytics | Week 11 | - | 11th Feb | Dr Igor Razgon | 25% |
| Image Processing | 15th Jan | 2nd Mar | 6th May | Dr George Koulieris | 25% |
| Probability and Graphics | May Exam | - | - | Razgon & Koulieris | 50% |

Table 1: Assessments for Data Science.

**Data Cleaning** & **Analytics Benchtest Information**: The Data Cleaning & Analytics test in Week 11 is a closed book, multiple choice test, and will be held during practicals (mine is Friday 4pm).

- Closed-book assessment over one hour. Check information closer to the time.
- Comprised of 15 multiple-choice questions, split equally between: basic NumPy, basic Pandas, data cleaning, data analytics, and visualisation.

## 1.2 Timetable

This module is taught through two one-hour lectures and one two-hour computer class each week as seen below in Table 2.

| Day | Time | Class Type | Location | Lecturer |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | 12:00 - 13:00 | Lecture | W103 | Dr Igor Razgon |
| Friday | 10:00 - 11:00 | Lecture | W103 | Dr Igor Razgon |
| Friday | 16:00 - 18:00 | Computer Class | CC-0007 | - |

Table 2: Michaelmas Term Timetable for Data Science.

# 2 Probability and Statistics

This section is taught by Dr Igor Razgon. The recommended reading for this topic is:

- Probability and Statistics (Degroot, M.H. and Schervish, M.J., 2012).

## 2.1 Probability and Statistics: Basic Concepts

### 2.1.1 Counting Theory

**Definition 2.1.1.1**: The product rule states that, if a procedure can be broken down into a sequence of two tasks with $n_1$ ways to do the first task and $n_2$ ways to do the second task, then there are $n_1 n_2$ ways to complete the entire procedure.

**Example 2.1.1.1**: John wants to fly to Canada from Germany with a connecting flight through the UK. There are 3 flights from Germany to the UK, and 2 flights from the UK to Canada. How many possible flight combinations are there?

*Solution*: $3 \times 2 = 6$.

□


*LaTeX File Template v.2.3.0: Copyright 2026, Matthew Emerson*

**Definition 2.1.1.2**: The sum rule states that, if you consider two independent sub-tasks (we only have to do one), if the first can be done in $n_1$ ways, and the second can be done in $n_2$ ways, then the total number of ways to complete the task is $n_1 + n_2$.

**Example 2.1.1.2**: Mary wants to choose a student project from three lists: lecturer 1 offers 5 projects, lecturer 2 offers 2 projects, and lecturer 3 offers 10 projects. How many possible options for her?
*Solution*: $5 + 2 + 10 = 17$.

□

**Definition 2.1.1.3**: The inclusion-exclusion principle states that, if two tasks can be done at the same time (unlike the sum rule in which they are independent), then there is a possibility of overcounting since some ways may be counted twice. To counter this, we add up the number of ways to do each task, then subtract the number of ways to do both tasks.

$$|A \cup B| = (|A| + |B|) - (|A \cap B|) \tag{1}$$

$$|A \cup B \cup C| = (|A| + |B| + |C|) - (|A \cap B| + |A \cap C| + |B \cap C|) + (|A \cap B \cap C|) \tag{2}$$

**Definition 2.1.1.4**: An r-permutation of a set of $r$ distinct objects is one ordered arrangement. We denote the number of r-permutations of a set with $n$ elements in as $P(n, r)$.

$$P(n, r) = n \times (n-1) \times (n-2) \times ... \times (n-r+1) = \frac{n!}{(n-r)!} \tag{3}$$

Suppose that a set consists of $n$ objects, of which $n_1$ are of one type (indistinguishable from one another), $n_2$ are of a second type, ..., and $n_k$ are of a $k_{th}$ type where $n = n_1 + n_2 + ... + n_k$. The number of permutations of the objects can be calculated with (4).

$$P(n; n_1, n_2, ..., n_k) = \frac{n!}{n_1! n_2! ... n_k!} \tag{4}$$

**Definition 2.1.1.5**: A r-combination is a counting of distinct objects in an unordered arrangement of length $r$. The number of $r$ combinations of a set with $n$ distinct elements is given by (5).

$$C(n, r) = \binom{n}{r} = \frac{n!}{(n-r)! \times r!} \tag{5}$$

**Example 2.1.1.3**: Assume elements $A_1, A_2, A_3, A_4$ are in a set. We want to choose 2 elements from them.
*Solution*:

- If the order of elements is important: $P(4, 2) = \frac{4!}{(4-2)!} = 12$.
- If the order of elements is not important: $C(4, 2) = \frac{4!}{(4-2)!2!} = 6$.

□

### 2.1.2 Probability Theory

**Definition 2.1.2.1**: Probability is the formalisation of uncertain events. It enables one to infer probabilities of interest based on assumptions and observations.

**Definition 2.1.2.2**: Statistics is the practice of the science of collecting and analysing data. It deals with experimental data and extracting knowledge from it.


*LaTeX File Template v.2.3.0: Copyright 2026, Matthew Emerson*

**Definition 2.1.2.3**: An experiment is a procedure that yields one of a given set of possible outcomes.

**Definition 2.1.2.4**: The sample space of the experiment is the set of possible outcomes.

**Definition 2.1.2.5**: An event is any subset of the sample space.

**Theorem 2.1.2.1**: The Theory of Probability states that, given a finite sample space of all outcomes $S$, assuming that all outcomes are equally likely, for an event set $E$ where $E \subseteq S$, then the probability of occurrence of the event is given by (6).

$$P(E) = \frac{|E|}{|S|} \tag{6}$$

*Proof*: Proof omitted.

□

**Definition 2.1.2.6**: The axioms of probability are as follows:

- $P(E)$ is always between 0 and 1: $0 \leq P(E) \leq 1$.
- $P(S) = 1$.
- For disjoint events $E_1, E_2, ..., E_n$ (with no intersection), $P(E_1 \cup E_2 \cup ... \cup E_n) = \sum_{i=1}^{n} P(E_i)$.

Then, from the Axioms of Probability above, we can derive the following:

- **Definition 2.1.2.7**: The complement rule states that $P(\overline{E}) = P(S - E) = P(S) - P(E) = 1 - P(E)$.
- **Definition 2.1.2.8**: The impossible rule states that $P(\emptyset) = 0$.
- **Definition 2.1.2.9**: The general addition rule states that $P(E_1 \cup E_2) = P(E_1) + P(E_2) - P(E_1 \cap E_2)$.
- If $E_1 \subseteq E_2$, then $P(E_1) \leq P(E_2)$.

**Example 2.1.2.1**: A sequence of 10 bits is randomly generated. What is the probability that at least 1 of these is 0?
*Solution*: Let $E$ be an event in which all bits are 1.

$$P(E) = \frac{|E|}{|S|} = \frac{1}{2^{10}}$$

Then, by the complement rule, $P(\overline{E}) = P(1 - E)$ where $\overline{E}$ is the event in which at least one bit is not 1.

$$P(\overline{E}) = 1 - \frac{1}{1024} = \frac{1023}{1024}$$

□

## 2.2 Dependency and Bayes Theorem

### 2.2.1 Conditional Probability

The probability of event A, given that event B happens is given by:

$$P(A|B) = \frac{P(A \cap B)}{P(B)} \tag{7}$$

Therefore, the probability of both A and B occuring can be given by:

$$P(A \cap B) = P(A|B) \times P(B) \tag{8}$$


*LaTeX File Template v.2.3.0: Copyright 2026, Matthew Emerson*

**Definition 2.2.1.1**: Events can occur independently. The occurrence of one event is not dependent on the occurrence of another if, and only if:

$$P(A \cap B) = P(A) \times P(B) \tag{9}$$

**Definition 2.2.1.2**: $P(A \cap B)$ can be presented in two ways, either $P(A|B) \times P(B)$ or $P(B|A) \times P(A)$. Equating these, we can obtain Bayes' Theorem.

$$P(A|B) = \frac{P(B|A) \times P(A)}{P(B)} \tag{10}$$

This can be rewritten by using variables, where $P(A|B)$ is the posterior, $P(A)$ is the prior, $P(B|A)$ is the likelihood, and $P(B)$ is the evidence.

$$posterior = \frac{likelihood \times prior}{evidence} \tag{11}$$

Suppose that $E_1, E_2, ..., E_n$ are mutually exclusive events such that:

$$\bigcup_{i=1}^{n} E_i = S \tag{12}$$

This means that one of the events **must** occur. Then, in any case, Bayes' Theorem states:

$$P(E_k|A) = \frac{P(E_k) \times P(A|E_k)}{\sum_{j=1}^{n} P(E_j) \times P(A|E_j)} \tag{13}$$

## 2.3 Discrete Probability Distributions

### 2.3.1 Random Variables

**Definition 2.3.1.1**: A random variable is a function that assigns a number to each outcome in the sample space of a random experiment. It is also known as a stochastic variable. They are usually denoted by a capital $X$ or $Y$.

**Definition 2.3.1.2**: We say that $X$ is a discrete random variable if $X$ can take a finite number of $k$ values $x_1, .x_2, ..., x_k$ and an infinite sequence of different values $x_1, x_2, ...$ which can be distinguished from one another.

**Definition 2.3.1.3**: The probability distribution of a random variable $X$ describes the probabilities associated with each possible outcome of $X$. Let $X$ be a discrete random variable. Suppose that the possible values it can assume are $x_1, x_2, ..., x_n$. Then, these values are associated with probabilities given by

$$P(X = x_k) = f(x_k), k = 1, 2, ..., n \tag{14}$$

This function $f$ is known as the probability mass function (PMF).

### 2.3.2 Distribution Functions

**Definition 2.3.2.1**: The probability mass function (PMF) is function where the value is a probability and has the following characteristics:

- $f(x_k) \geq 0$.
- $\sum_{k=1}^{n} f(x_k) = 1$.


*LaTeX File Template v.2.3.0: Copyright 2026, Matthew Emerson*

The mathematical definition is that, for a discrete random variable $X$ with possible values $x_1, x_2, ...$ the probability mass function is a function $f : \{x_1, x_2, ...\} \to [0, 1]$ satisfying $f(x_i) \geq 0$, $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} f(x_i) = 1$, and $P(X = x_i) = f(x_i)$. They can be calculated by collecting all possible outcomes where $X = x$ and summing their probabilities for all $x$.

**Definition 2.3.2.2**: The cumulative distribution function (CDF) or distribution function for a random variable $X$ is defined as

$$F(x) = P(X \leq x) = \sum_{x_i \leq x} P(X = x_i) = \sum_{x_i \leq x} f(x_i), \text{ where } x \in \mathbb{R} \tag{15}$$

**Definition 2.3.2.3**: The mean ($\mu$) or expected value $E$ of a function is the measure of dispersion or variability in a distribution.

**Definition 2.3.2.4**: The variance of a function is the measure of dispersion or variability in a distribution.

It is important to consider two laws when discussing random variables:

1. Functions of random variables are also random variables. Let $X$ be a random variable, and $h : \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}$ be an arbitrary function. Then $Y = h(X)$ is also a random variable.
2. **Definition 2.3.2.5**: The law of the unconscious statistician: Let $X$ be a random variable with PMF $f$ and $h : \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}$ be an arbitrary function. Then $Y = h(X)$ is also a random variable. If $X$ is discrete and takes values $\{x_1, x_2, ...\}$ then

$$E[Y] = E[h(x)] = \sum_i h(x_i) f(x_i) \tag{16}$$

These two laws result in the conclusion that one can perform arithmetic operations with random variables to get new ones, and the expectation and variance can be computed from them.

- $E(aX + b) = aE[X] + b$.
- $E[h(X)] = \sum_x h(x) f(x)$.
- $V(aX + b) = a^2 V(X)$.
- $V(X) = E(X^2) - [E(X)]^2$.

From this, $E[X]$ is named the first moment, and $E[X]^2$ is the second moment. The variance is also called the central second moment.

We can consider two random variables $X$ and $Y$ to be independent if, for sets $A$ and $B$, we have

$$P(\{X \in A\} \cap \{Y \in B\}) \equiv P(X \in A, Y \in B) = P(X \in A) P(Y \in B) \tag{17}$$

For independent random variables only, we have

$$V(X_1 + X_2 + ... + X_n) = V(X_1) + V(X_2) + ... + V(X_n) \tag{18}$$

This equation holds for expectation $E$, whether the variables are independent or not.

### 2.3.3 Special Discrete Distributions

**Definition 2.3.3.1**: The discrete uniform distribution is the simplest discrete random variable. It assumes a finite number of possible values, each with equal probability. A random variable $X$ has a discrete uniform distribution if each of the $n$ values in its range $x_1, x_2, ..., x_n$ has equal probability. Suppose random variable $X$ has uniform distribution. The probability mass function of $X$ is given by ($X \sim Uni(n)$).

$$P(X = k) = f(k) = \frac{1}{n} \tag{19}$$


*LaTeX File Template v.2.3.0: Copyright 2026, Matthew Emerson*

If we assume $X$ is a discete uniform distribution on the consecutive integers $a, a+1, a+2, ..., b$ for $a < b$, then:

$$\mu = E[X] = \frac{a+b}{2} \tag{20}$$

$$\sigma^2 = Var(X) = \frac{(b-a+1)^2 - 1}{12} \tag{21}$$

**Definition 2.3.3.2**: The most common discrete distributions are associated with Bernoulli trials. In a random experiment if each outcome consists of only two probabilities, such as in a toss of a coin, then the random experiment is called a Bernoulli trial. In a Bernoulli trial, let the possible events in each outcome be denoted by $A$ and $B$. Then, $A \cap B = \emptyset$ and $A \cup B = S$. Let the occurrence of $A$ be a success, and the occurrence of $B$ be a fail and let the probability of $A$ be $p$, then:

$$P(B) = P(\overline{A}) = 1 - P(A) = 1 - p = q \tag{22}$$

Let $X$ be a random variable taking only two possible values $\{0, 1\}$ and let $p = P(X = 1)$. Then $X$ is said to be a Bernoulli random variable with parameter $p$: $X \sim Ber(p)$, then:

$$E[X] = 0 \times P(X = 0) + 1 \times P(X = 1) = p \tag{23}$$

$$E[X^2] = 0^2 \times P(X = 0) + 1^2 \times P(X = 1) = p \tag{24}$$

$$V(X) = E[X^2] - (E[X])^2 = p - p^2 = p(1-p) \tag{25}$$

Taking (22) and (25), we get that $E[X] = p$ and $V(X) = pq$.

**Definition 2.3.3.3**: Consider a random experiment consisting of $n \in \mathbb{N}$ independent Bernoulli trials. If the probability of success for each trial equals $p$, $0 \leq p \leq 1$, and it remains the same throughout the experiment, then we say that the random variable $X$ that equals the number of successful trials is a binomial random variable with parameters $n$ and $p$. The probability mass function of $X$ is given by $X \sim Bin(n, p)$.

$$P(X = k) = f(k) = \binom{n}{k} p^k (1-p)^{n-k}, k = 0, 1, ..., n \tag{26}$$

The binomial random variable is $n$ independent repetitions of a Bernoulli variable, $X = X_1 + X_2 + ... + X_n$. So we can calculate

$$E[X] = E[X_1 + X_2 + ... + E_n] = E[X_1] + E[X_2] + ... + E[X_n] \tag{27}$$

$$V(X) = V[X_1 + X_2 + ... + X_n] = V(X_1) + V(X_2) + ... + V(X_n) \tag{28}$$

Therefore, $E[X] = np$ and $V(X) = np(1-p)$.

**Definition 2.3.3.4**: Consider a series of independent Bernoulli trials with constant probability of success $p$. Let the random variable $X$ denote the number of trials until the first success. Then $X$ is called a geometric random variable with parameter $p$: $X \sim Geom(p)$.

$$P(X = k) = f(k) = p(1-p)^{k-1}, k = 1, 2, ... \tag{29}$$

and $E[X] = \frac{1}{p}$ and $V(X) = \frac{1-p}{p^2}$.

**Theorem 2.3.3.1**: The geometric distribution has no memory of the past. This is called the memoryless property, meaning that if you have waited $k$ trials already without seeing a success, you must wait $m$ more trials to get success with probability of $p(1-p)^{m-1}$: $P(X = k + m | X > k) = P(X = m)$.

*Proof*:

$$P(X = k + m | X > k) = \frac{P(\{X = k + m\} \cap \{X > k\})}{P(\{X > k\})} \tag{30}$$

$$\frac{P(X = k + m)}{P(X > k)} = \frac{P(X = k + m)}{1 - P(X \geq k)} \tag{31}$$

$$= \frac{p(1-p)^{k+m-1}}{(1-p)^k} = p(1-p)^{m-1} = P(X = m) \tag{32}$$


*LaTeX File Template v.2.3.0: Copyright 2026, Matthew Emerson*

□

**Definition 2.3.3.5**: We can generalise the idea behind the geometric distribution - instead of waiting for the first success, we can wait until $r$ successes. Consider a series of independent Bernoulli trials with constant success probability $p$. Let the random variable $X$ denote the number of trials until $r \in \mathbb{N}$ successes are attained. Then $X$ is called a negative binomial random variable with parameter $p$ and $r$: $X \sim NegBin(p, r)$.

$$P(X = k) = f(k) = \begin{cases} 0, \text{ if } k < r \\ \binom{k-1}{r-1} p^r (1-p)^{k-r}, \text{ if } k \geq r \end{cases} \quad , \text{ where } k \in \mathbb{N} \tag{33}$$

Then $E[X] = \frac{r}{p}$ and $V(X) = r\frac{1-p}{p^2}$.

**Definition 2.3.3.6**: Suppose that you want to model the number of customers entering a store over the period of one day. To do this we make two assumptions: the customers behave independently from one another and the expected number of customers per unit of time is constant $\lambda$.

Breaking the day into four-hour intervals gives six pieces ($n = 6$), so the expected number of customers for each interval is $\frac{\lambda}{n} = \frac{\lambda}{6}$. If the intervals are really small, then the number of customers is either 0 or 1 with very high probability. Then the number of customers in each interval is approximately a Bernoulli random variable with $p = \frac{\lambda}{n}$, they are also all independent.

Now look at getting $k$ arrivals in a $Bin(n, p)$, where the number of bins $n$ grows towards $+\infty$. In this case, the probability of a single event will be $p = \frac{\lambda}{n}$.

A Poisson random variable has a distribution that shows how many times an event is likely to happen within a specific period of time. $X$ is called a Poisson random variable with parameter $\lambda > 0$. It is the number of events in a Poisson process, $X \sim Poisson(\lambda)$.

$$P(X = k) = f(k) = \frac{e^{-\lambda}\lambda^k}{k!}, k = 0, 1, 2, ... \tag{34}$$

and $E[X] = \lambda$ and $V(X) = \lambda$.

## 2.4 Continuous Probability Distributions

### 2.4.1 Continuous Random Variables

**Definition 2.4.1.1**: A continuous random variable is a random variable such that the probability of any one specific value is unknown, and thus is treated as zero. Instead, we calculate the probability of the value being in a given interval.

**Definition 2.4.1.2**: In general, continuous random variables are described by a probability density function. It maps a probability of a range of events from the sample space to a function. The probability density function of a continuous random variable $X$ is denoted $f_X$ or simply $f$.

$$P(a \leq X \leq b) = \int_a^b f_X(x)dx \tag{35}$$

We define the probability density function $f(x)$ for a continuous random variable $X$ such that:

- $f(x) \geq 0, \forall x \in \mathbb{R}$.
- $\int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} f(x)dx = 1$.
- $P(a \leq X \leq b) = \int_a^b f(x)dx, \forall (a, b) | (a, b) \in \mathbb{R}^2, a \leq b$.

**Definition 2.4.1.3**: Similarly, we can define the continuous cumulative distribution function $F(x) : \mathbb{R} \to [0, 1]$ of a continuous random variable $X$ where $x \in \mathbb{R}$ as

$$F(x) = P(X \leq x) = \int_{-\infty}^{x} f(t)dt \tag{36}$$

As in the discrete case, a continuous CDF has the following properties:


*LaTeX File Template v.2.3.0: Copyright 2026, Matthew Emerson*

- $F(x)$ is non-decreasing: if $x \leq y$ then $F(x) \leq F(y)$.
- $0 \leq F(x) \leq 1$: $\lim_{x \to -\infty} F(x) = 0$, $\lim_{x \to +\infty} F(x) = 1$.
- For $a \leq b$ we have: $P(a \leq X \leq b) = F(b) - F(a)$.

If $F(x)$ is the cumulative distribution function of a continuous random variable $X$, then its derivative is the probability distribution function $f(x)$.

$$f(x) = F'(x) = \frac{d}{dx}F(x) \tag{37}$$

**Example 2.4.1.1**: A continuous random variable $X$ has the density function (38). Find the value of the constant $c$.

$$f(x) = \frac{c}{x^2 + 1} \text{ where } -\infty < x < +\infty \tag{38}$$

*Solution*: From Definition 2.4.1.3, we know that

$$F(+\infty) = P(X \leq +\infty) = \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} f(t)dt = 1 \tag{39}$$

Substituting in $f(x)$, we get

$$\int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} \frac{c}{x^2 + 1}dx = [\arctan(x)]_{-\infty}^{+\infty} = 1 \tag{40}$$

$$c \lim_{x \to \infty} [(\arctan(x) - \arctan(-x))]_{-\infty}^{+\infty} = c\left[\left(\frac{\pi}{2}\right) - \left(-\frac{\pi}{2}\right)\right] = 1 \tag{41}$$

This gives us that, $1 = c\pi$, giving $c = \frac{1}{\pi}$.

□

### 2.4.2 Mean and Variance

Going back to the continuous random variable $X$, we can define its mean and variance as values to summarise its distribution such that,

$$\mu = E[X] = \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} xf(x)dx \tag{42}$$

and

$$\sigma^2 = V(X) = E\left[(X - \mu)^2\right] = \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} (x - \mu)^2 f(x)dx \tag{43}$$

As for discrete random variables, mean and variance have the following properties:

- $E[aX + b] = aE[X] + b$.
- $V(aX + b) = a^2V(X)$.
- $\sqrt{V(aX + b)} = |a|\sqrt{V(X)}$.


*LaTeX File Template v.2.3.0: Copyright 2026, Matthew Emerson*

### 2.4.3 Specific Continuous Distributions

**Definition 2.4.3.1**: The continuous uniform distribution sets all samples in a range as having the same probability. Formally, let $X$ be a continuous random variable with density function

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{b-a}, \text{ if } a \leq x \leq b \\ 0, \text{ otherwise} \end{cases} \tag{44}$$

We have that the mean and variance of this distribution are $E(X) = \frac{b+a}{2}$ and $V(X) = \frac{(b-a)^2}{12}$.

**Definition 2.4.3.2**: The exponential distribution is used to model the time elapsing between events. The probability of occurrence of an event after a unit of time. It has a parameter $\lambda$ which is the rate parameter and is the average number of events occuring in a period of one time unit.

Formally, a random variable $X$ is called an exponential random variable with parameter $\lambda > 0$ (denoted by $X \sim Exp(\lambda)$) when the probability density function is

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \lambda e^{-\lambda x}, \text{ if } x \geq 0 \\ 0, \text{ otherwise} \end{cases} \tag{45}$$

and

$$F(x) = \begin{cases} 1 - e^{-\lambda x}, \text{ if } x \geq 0 \\ 0, \textit{ otherwise} \end{cases} \tag{46}$$

We can then define the mean and variance as $E(X) = \frac{1}{\lambda}$ and $V(X) = \frac{1}{\lambda^2}$.

## 2.5 Normal (Gaussian) Distributions

### 2.5.1 Introduction to the Normal Distribution

**Definition 2.5.1.1**: A normal distribution usually represents the sum of many independent random variables, and almost always looks like a bell curve. These bell curves can have different centres and spreads depending on the mean $\mu$ and variance $\sigma^2$ of the random variables.

Formally, a random variable $X$ is said to have normal distribution with parameters mean $-\infty < \mu < +\infty$ and variance $\sigma^2, \sigma > 0$, written as $X \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2)$. The probability density function is defined as:

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma^2}} e^{-\frac{(x-\mu)^2}{2\sigma^2}} \tag{47}$$

with $E(X) = \mu$ and $Var(X) = \sigma^2$.

### 2.5.2 The Standard Normal Distribution

**Definition 2.5.2.1**: The standard normal distribution is a special case of the normal distribution defined formally as: A random variable $Z$ with probability density function as follows is called a standard normal random variable:

$$f(z) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} e^{-\frac{z^2}{2}} \tag{48}$$

This is a normal random variable with parameters $\mu = 0$ and $\sigma^2 = 1$. The corresponding cumulative distribution function is denoted as $\Phi(z) = P(Z \leq z)$. This means that any normal distribution $X$ can be converted into a standard normal distribution $Z$ using the formula $Z = \frac{X-\mu}{\sigma}$. This is called the z-score or Z-score, and can be used to compare scores from distributions with different scales, or to determine the relationship between one score and the rest. Before using the normal approximation $P(X \leq x)$ should be changed to $P(X \leq x + 0.5)$.


*LaTeX File Template v.2.3.0: Copyright 2026, Matthew Emerson*

#### 2.5.3 Normal Approximations

When you have a binomial distribution where $n$ is large and $p$ is the middle-of-the-road, then the binomial distribution tends to look like a normal distribution.

$$X \sim \text{Bin}(n,p) \Rightarrow P(X \leq x) \approx \Phi\left(\frac{x-np}{\sqrt{npq}}\right) \tag{49}$$

This approximation is generally good for $np > 5$ and $n(1-p) > 5$.

If $X$ is a Poisson random variable with $E(X) = \lambda$ and $V(X) = \lambda$, then

$$X \sim \text{Poisson}(\lambda) \Rightarrow P(X \leq x) \approx \Phi\left(\frac{x-\lambda}{\sqrt{\lambda}}\right) \tag{50}$$

The same continuity correction used for the binomial distribution can also be applied. The approximation is good for $\lambda > 5$.

### 2.6 Correlations

### 2.7 Central Limit Theorem and Sampling

### 2.8 Hypothesis Testing

### 2.9 Data Types and Visualisation

### 2.10 Basic Data Analysis with Python

## 3 Data Cleaning and Analytics

This section is taught by Dr Igor Razgon. The recommended reading for this topic is:

- Python for Data Analytics (McKinney, 2022).

### 3.1 Data Quality and How to Produce High-Quality Data

#### 3.1.1 Data Quality

**Definition 3.1.1.1**: Data cleansing is the process of detecting and correcting (or removing) corrupt or inaccurate records from a record set, table, or database and refers to identifying incomplete, inaccurate, or irrelevant parts of the data and then replacing, modifying, or deleting the dirty or coarse data.

For data to be considered high-quality, it should meet the following criteria:

- **Definition 3.1.1.2**: Validity: The degree to which the measures conform to defined business rules or constraints.
- **Definition 3.1.1.3**: Accuracy: The degree of conformity of a measure to a standard or a true value.
- **Definition 3.1.1.4**: Completeness: The degree to which all required measures are known.
- **Definition 3.1.1.5**: Consistency: The degree to which the data is consistent, within the same data set or across multiple data sets.
- **Definition 3.1.1.6**: Uniformity: The degree to which the data is specified using the same unit of measure.


*LaTeX File Template v.2.3.0: Copyright 2026, Matthew Emerson*

### 3.1.2 How to Produce High-Quality Data

Producing high-quality data is an iterative process moving through inspection, cleaning, verifying, and reporting.

**Definition 3.1.2.1**: Inspection: Detect unexpected, incorrect, and inconsistent data.

- **Definition 3.1.2.2**: Data profiling is the process of viewing the summary statistics of your data to identify standards or patterns in columns of data. Here it is also important to note the data type, any missing values, the number of unique values, the distribution of values, and the relationship between the data and other columns.
- Visualising the data can also be helpful for identifying outliers, as can using statistical methods such as mean, standard deviation, range, and/or quartiles.

**Definition 3.1.2.3**: Cleaning: Fix or remove the anomalies detected.

- It is important to identify and remove duplicate entries in your data sets.
- When converting the data into a consistent data type, values unable to fit the format should be flagged and converted to NA value.
- Beyond the data types, the data should be further standardised. This means strings are of a consistent capitalisation, numerical values use the same measurement unit, and dates are in the same format (pick either the UK or US format).
- It can also be useful to scale/transform your data to fit within a certain scale (i.e. 0-100 or 0-1). This can make data easier to plot (e.g., exponential data being logged).
- You can either replace missing values by using a mask to indicate where they are missing, or choosing a sentinel value to replace the missing entries. Conversely, you can also drop the whole record from the data set, or where possible calculate the missing values from other observations.
- **Definition 3.1.2.4**: We define outliers as values which fall 1.5 times the interquartile range from both the first and third quartiles.

**Definition 3.1.2.5**: Verifying: After cleaning, the results are inspected to verify correctness.

**Definition 3.1.2.6**: Reporting: A report about the changes made and the quality of the currently stored data is recorded.

## 3.2 Working with Files

There is no new content here, it is just an introduction to Python's file read/write operations.

## 3.3 Pandas and Numpy

There is no new content here, it is just an introduction to Pandas and Numpy.

## 3.4 Data Cleaning and Preparation

### 3.4.1 Missing Values and Duplicates

See notes from Artificial Intelligence.


*LaTeX File Template v.2.3.0: Copyright 2026, Matthew Emerson*

### 3.4.2 Removal of Outliers

**Definition 3.4.2.1**: When trying to identify outliers, we need to provide precise specifications for a rare occurrence. For this, we generally use one of three interpretations:

- *Threshold Limit*: We set some threshold limit, say 3, and all values that occur fewer than 3 times are considered outliers.
- *Threshold Limit for Clusters*: We classify all the values into several classes and again set a limit, say 3. A value is considered an outlier if its class occurs fewer than 3 times.
- *Quartiles-Based*: We apply a standard statistical methodology involving quartiles and interquartile range.

### 3.4.3 Splitting and Merging

See notes from Artificial Intelligence.

## 3.5 Python Data Visualisation Libraries

## 3.6 Data Analytics and Reporting

# 4 Computer Graphics

This section is taught by Dr George Alex Koulieris. Check for recommended reading.

# 5 Image Processing

This section is taught by Dr George Alex Koulieris. Check for recommended reading.


*LaTeX File Template v.2.3.0: Copyright 2026, Matthew Emerson*

# Part I
# Appendix

## 6 Bibliography

### 6.1 Module Professors

**Module Lead**: Professor Thomas Erlebach

- Focus: Algorithms and networks.
- Email: thomas.erlebach@durham.ac.uk
- Office Hours: n/a.

**Lecturer**: Doctor Igor Razgon

- Focus: Algorithms and complexity, graph theory, and discrete mathematics.
- Email: igor.razgon@durham.ac.uk
- Office Hours: Friday 14:00 - 15:00.

**Lecturer**: Doctor George Alex Koulieris

- Focus: Imagr processing and computer graphics.
- Email: georgios.a.koulieris@durham.ac.uk
- Office Hours: Please email to make an appointment.

### 6.2 References

### 6.3 List of Figures

### 6.4 Reading List

#### 6.4.1 Probability

Degroot, M.H. and Schervish, M.J. (2012). Probability and Statistics. Boston Mass.: Pearson.

#### 6.4.2 Data Cleaning and Analytics

McKinney, W. (2022). Python for Data Analysis. O'Reilly Media, Inc.